

Utility Assistance — Energy & Water

Behind on gas, electric, heating, or water? You may qualify for federal and local programs that help pay what you owe and keep your service on. Below are the most trusted national starting points. Tick the box once you've contacted each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Call your utility company first and ask for their hardship program, payment plan, or budget billing — and tell them if you've had a shut-off notice. Then apply to the programs below. A real assistance program never charges a fee just to apply.

1 Federal Energy Bill Help (LIHEAP)

LIHEAP is the main federal program for heating, cooling, and electricity costs. You apply through your state or local Community Action Agency.

☐ LIHEAP — Low Income Home Energy Assistance Program

Helps pay heating and cooling bills, and in many states helps during an energy crisis or shut-off. Find your state's program and how to apply.

→ www.acf.hhs.gov/ocs/programs/liheap

☐ LIHEAP Help Line

Call to find the office that takes applications in your area.

→ 1-866-674-6327 **National Energy Assistance Referral**

2 Help With Your Water Bill

The federal water assistance program (LIHWAP) has ended, so water help now comes from your water company and local agencies. These are the best places to start.

☐ Your Water Company — Hardship & Payment Plans

Most water utilities have low-income discounts, payment plans, or shut-off protection. Call the number on your bill and ask what they offer.

→ **Call the number on your water bill**

☐ 211 — Local Water & Utility Help

Call or search to find local programs that help with overdue water and utility bills.

→ www.211.org or dial 211

3 Local Hands-On Help

Community agencies and charities help you apply, cover emergency bills, and prevent shut-offs — often for several utilities at once.

☐ Community Action Agency — Find Yours

Local agencies run LIHEAP and other utility help, and can walk you through applying.

→ communityactionpartnership.com/find-a-cap

☐ Dollar Energy Fund

Works with utility companies to help pay overdue energy and water bills.

→ www.dollarenergy.org

☐ Salvation Army — Utility Assistance

Local branches may help with emergency utility bills. Availability depends on funding.

→ www.salvationarmyusa.org

4 Lower Your Bills For Good (Weatherization)

Free home energy upgrades — insulation, weather-sealing, repairs — that permanently cut your energy bills. No cost to eligible households.

☐ Weatherization Assistance Program (WAP)

Free energy-saving improvements for income-eligible homes. Find how to apply in your state.

→ www.energy.gov/scep/wap/how-apply-weatherization-assistance

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

Old websites still list “LIHWAP” water grants — that federal program ended and is no longer taking applications. Use your water company and 211 instead.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Apply before you’re disconnected. Many programs offer emergency help or can stop a shut-off if you reach out in time. Funds often run out, so apply early in the season.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Ask for your personalized utility search

This guide covers the main national programs. For help specific to your city, county, or ZIP code — including your local utility’s own programs — use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area, and we’ll help you find the closest options and apply.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
